ERIC SAN MIGUEL

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EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University (Penn State) 2021 – present
Ph.D. in Economics (expected May 2027)

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM) 2019 – 2021
M.A. in Economic Theory (with highest honors)

Centro de Investigación y Docencia Económicas (CIDE) 2015 – 2019
B.A. in Economics (with highest honors)

- Exchange student at Universitat Pompeu Fabra (UPF), Barcelona. Spring 2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields: Industrial Organization, Health Economics, Applied Micro

WORKING PAPERS

- **Medicare and Hospital Quality** (Job Market Paper)

  This paper studies how Medicare payment policy shapes the quality of hospital care. I build a structural model of hospital quality choice and hospital–insurer bargaining in which quality attracts both Medicare and commercial patients, affects negotiated prices, and increases the cost of treating patients. I estimate the model using Medicare and commercial claims from Massachusetts. I find that patients of both payers value quality similarly, but that commercial margins are much larger and negotiated commercial prices respond to quality about 17 times more than Medicare's quality adjustment. As a result, on average, commercial patients account for 81 percent of hospitals' marginal return to quality, despite making up only 34 percent of demand. Therefore, as the population ages through 2040 and Medicare's share increases, equilibrium quality and average patient welfare fall. A budget-neutral reform that makes Medicare rates more responsive to quality prevents this decline, but its payments and quality gains concentrate at the highest-quality, highest-margin hospitals.

- **Horizontal Mergers Post-Deregulation: The Case of the Mexico City Retail Gasoline Market**
- **Criminal Politicians, Political Parties, and Selection: Evidence from Indian National Elections** (with Amrutha Manjunath)

SEMINARS, WORKSHOPS, AND CONFERENCES

2026: University of Nottingham (Nottingham, UK), Penn State IO Brownbag, ITAM Alumni Conference (Mexico City, Mexico), 33rd European Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (Vienna, Austria), Penn State

2023 – 2025: Penn State IO Brownbag

DISTINCTIONS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Ed Green Graduate Fund (USD 1,000 in research support), Penn State 2026

Second Place, Graduate Exhibition (Social and Behavioral Sciences), Penn State 2026

Will E. Mason Memorial Award for best thesis proposal, Penn State 2025

RGSO Dissertation Competition Award (USD 7,000), Penn State 2024

Graduate Assistantship, Penn State 2021 – present

Full Tuition Scholarship, ITAM 2019 – 2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Research Assistant to Prof. Paul Grieco. Penn State
2024 – present

- Provided research assistance for the paper **Optimal Estimation of Discrete Choice Demand Models with Consumer and Product Data** (Grieco, Murry, Pinkse, and Sagl, 2025). R&R at *Econometrica*.

Doctoral Research Assistant to Prof. Bradley Setzler. Penn State
Summer 2023

Research Assistant to Prof. Emilio Gutiérrez. ITAM
August 2019 – December 2020

Research Assistant to Prof. Alexander Dentler. CIDE
September 2018 – June 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Ph.D. Courses (Industrial Organization), Department of Economics. Penn State
Fall 2023, Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant for Undergrad. Courses (Econometrics, Applied and Comp. Econ.) Penn State
Fall 2021 – Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant (Thesis Seminar, Development Econ.), Department of Economics. ITAM
January 2021 – July 2021

SKILLS

Computer Skills	R, Stata, QGIS, LaTeX, Julia, HPC (Roar supercomputer at Penn State): Linux/Unix, SLURM
Languages	Spanish (native), English (fluent)

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship:	Mexico, Spain (EU)
Work Authorization:	US F1 visa; USMCA TN visa eligible